



SQL ENGINEERING HANDBOOK

Certifications

Validating SQL fluency and cloud data skills

Certifications

Part of the [Resources Library](#) — [SQL Engineering Handbook](#)

Certifications don't replace a portfolio — the projects in [projects/](#) do more for a job application than a badge does. But a recognized certification is a fast, external signal of a specific skill, and worth it once the underlying skill is already real.

Certification	Issuer	Best For	Free / Paid
Oracle Database SQL Certified Associate	Oracle	A formally recognized, vendor-neutral-in-spirit SQL fundamentals credential	Paid (exam fee)
Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Fundamentals (DP-900)	Microsoft	Entry-level validation for the Microsoft/Azure data stack	Paid (exam fee)
SnowPro Core Certification	Snowflake	Validating Snowflake-specific warehouse knowledge for a role using it	Paid (exam fee)
SQL (Basic) / SQL (Advanced) Certificates	HackerRank	A free, fast, widely recognized signal of SQL fluency, shareable directly on LinkedIn	Free
dbt Analytics Engineering Certification	dbt Labs	Signaling dbt/analytics-engineering competency specifically	Paid (exam fee)

[!TIP] If choosing one, HackerRank's SQL certificates are the lowest-cost way to get a credible, verifiable signal while you're still building the portfolio projects that do the real convincing.

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